

Menstrual care

Menstrual care products are designed to keep girls and women feeling comfortable during their period. There are many products, but all enable someone who's menstruating to conveniently dispose of their shed menstrual blood in a way that meets their own needs.

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◀ 36–37 The menstrual cycle

Individual choice

There are lots of options available to deal with menstrual blood lost during a period. Many teens start out using menstrual pads and continue to use them, while others try other options, such as tampons and menstrual cups. Whatever product somebody chooses, it can take practice to become familiar with how to use it effectively. It's worth talking to an adult or friend to see what they've found works best for them.



ALERT!

Proper disposal

Menstrual pads can be rolled into the wrapper of the next pad, and tampons into toilet paper, before being placed in a trash can. Empty menstrual cups directly into the toilet before cleaning. Never flush menstrual products down the toilet.



◀ Many options available

Choose a product that's comfortable and convenient.

Menstrual pads

Made of a cottonlike material, menstrual pads protect clothes and help avoid discomfort by absorbing the blood of a period and keeping it away from the body. To suit people's needs at different stages of their period, there are three main types of menstrual pad, which come in different sizes and thicknesses. Making a decision about which to use depends on the heaviness or lightness of a period.

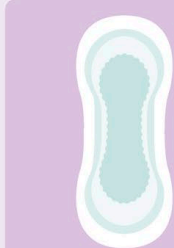
▽ Pads

These have an adhesive underside to keep the menstrual pad fixed in place.



△ Panty liner

These thinner, lighter pads are used when a period is light or very light, known as spotting.



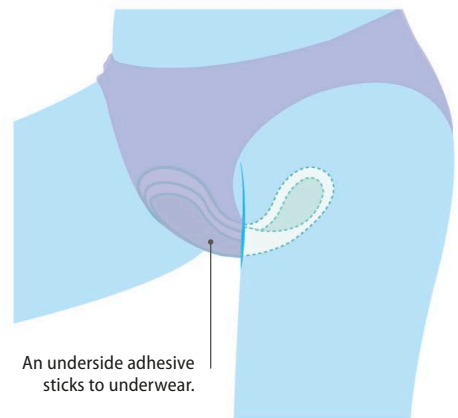
△ Pad

These thicker and more absorbent pads are used when the blood lost during a period is medium to heavy.



△ Pad with wings

Sticky side panels can be folded over the sides of underwear to improve protection and help users feel more secure.



An underside adhesive sticks to underwear.